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Introduction



A properly maintained computer *gives higher speeds*, may it be via RAM or on the Internet, regardless of hardware set-up and configurations. This lesson will give some tips on how to maintain computer systems and networks over time.

Icons made by [Creaticca.Creative.Agency](https://www.creaticca.com/) from www.flaticon.com

TOPIC 1: Routine Maintenance

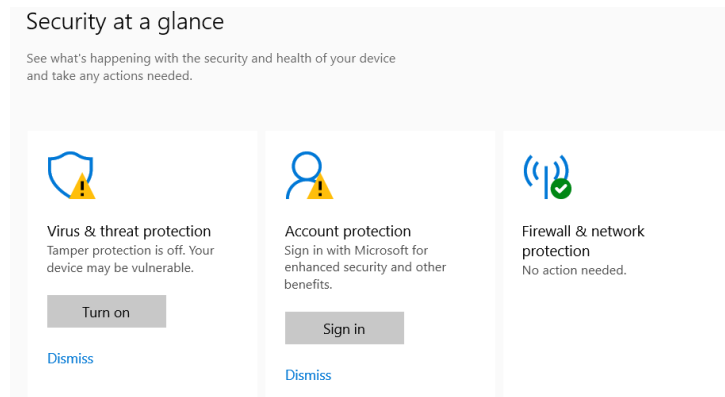
Clean browsers.

Use the computer's Disk Cleanup Utility included in the Windows System. In the same way, you can also download third party, freeware programs such as **CCleaner** to do the clean-up for you.

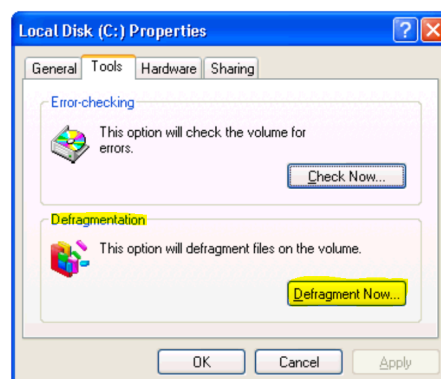


Search and delete spyware and viruses from the device.

Third party softwares like AVG Anti Virus can be used for maintenance. Or use the Windows Security built in on Windows 10 devices.

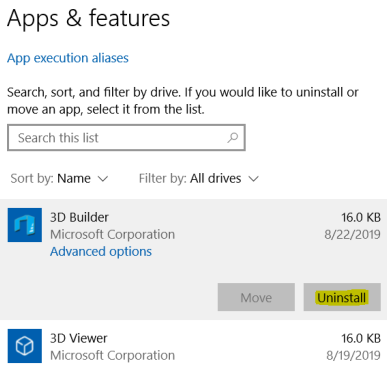


Defragment the hard drive routinely to keep the device running smoothly.



Uninstall programs that are no longer used.

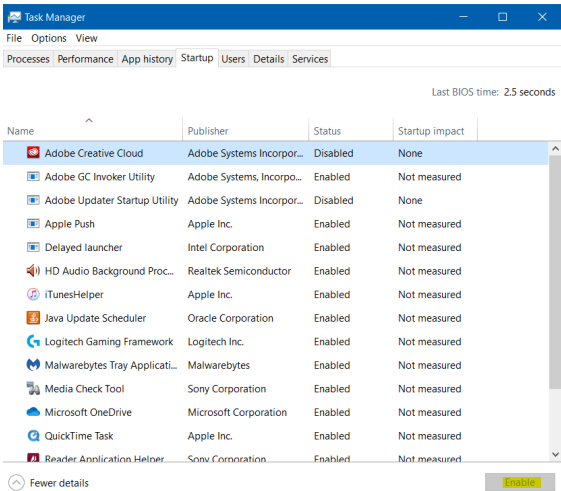
Delete files that are no longer needed. The freer space a computer has, the faster it will perform. The computer’s performace will increase.



Remove startup programs.

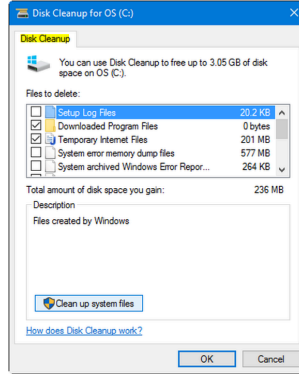
Use the msconfig command in the RUN command prompt to open up a window that will allow you to uncheck startup programs that are no longer used.

Doing this will improve start up and boot down times a lot. Third party softwares such as CCleaner can also be used for this purpose.



Use your computer’s disk management systems.

For Windows, select Performace and Maintenance. Choose “Rearrance items on your hard disk...” and “Free up space on your hard disk.” Or simply run Disk Cleanup.



Maintenance Basics



How to Perform Disk Clean Up:

1. Start Menu > Programs > Accessories > System Tools > Disk Clean Up
2. Select Drive to Clean Up > Click Ok
3. Check all items that need to be removed > Click Ok

How to Clear Internet History

1. Start Menu > Settings > Control Panel > Click Internet Options
2. Click "Clear History"
3. Click Ok

How to Clear Internet "Temporary Internet" Files

1. Start Menu > Settings > Control Panel > Click Internet Options
2. Click "Delete Files"
3. Check "Delete All Offline Content"
4. Click Ok

How to Run Scan disk and Disk Defragmenter without Interruption:

1. Start Menu > Run > In Run, type "MSCONFIG", then click Ok MSCONFIG will appear.
2. Select "Selective Startup"
3. Uncheck "Load Startup Group Items". Click Ok.
4. Click Yes to Restart Computer Upon Restart.
5. Start Menu > Settings > Control Panel > Click Display
6. Select the "Screen Saver" tab.
7. Change the Screen Saver Drop menu to "None". Click Ok.

Then Perform Scan Disk,

Start Menu > Programs > Accessories > System Tools > Scan Disk

After Scan Disk, Perform Disk Defragmenter

Start Menu > Programs > Accessories > System Tools > Disk Defragmenter > Select which disk to Defragment.
Click Ok.

After Disk Defragmenter

Start Menu > Run > In Run, type "MSCONFIG", click Ok. MSCONFIG will appear. Select "Normal Start Up", click Ok.
Click Yes to Restart Computer Upon Restart

Start Menu > Settings > Control Panel > Click Display

Select the "Screen Saver" tab.

Change the Screen Saver Drop menu to "None". Click Ok.

TOPIC 2: Tips on Maintaining Hardware

(1) Always run your computer on an Uninterruptible Power Supply (UPS).

It is an electrical apparatus that gives emergency power when a computer's main power fails. This will help **protect the device from electric surges**. Phone lines for modems and cat 5 or cat 6 network lines also need surge suppression as they can and will take out your network card or modem in an electric storm.



(2) Open up your computer.

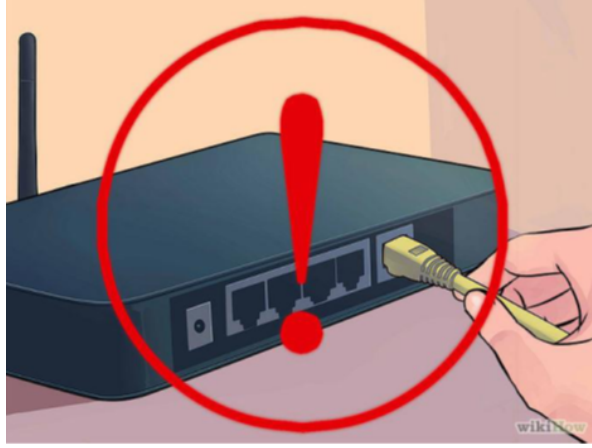
Dust can accumulate in your computer in less than a year, depending on how dusty your house. Check every few months.

Make sure to follow proper computer assembly and disassembly.



(3) Be careful when plugging peripherals to the computer.

Ports can be easily damaged when mishandled. These repairs can be quite costly.



Courtesy: Wikihow